Four-Suit Transfers

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Four-suit transfers are a method of transferring into any suit after partner opens 1NT. The transfer bids are:

Response to 1NT	Meaning
2♦	Jacoby transfer to ♥
2♥	Jacoby transfer to ♠
2♠	transfer to ♣
2NT	transfer to ♦

Because Jacoby transfers are already discussed separately on this site, let's focus on the minor suit transfers. The 2♠ and 2NT bids are used on the following types of hands:

- A weak hand with a 6+ card minor lacking interest in game. The purpose is to let the strong hand (opener) play the contract and conceal high cards from the defenders.
- A strong hand with a 5+ card minor with interest in slam.

Note the gap in values between "weak" and "strong" hands. If responder has values for game but not slam, she should either begin by bidding 2♣ Stayman with a 4-card major, or by bidding 3NT immediately.

Examples

Partner	You	
1NT (15-17)	?	
	♠542 ♥83 ♦93 ♣KJ8763	Bid 2♠, intending to pass after partner bids 3♣.
	♠5 ♥83 ♦QJT873 ♣7632	Bid 2NT, and pass after partner bids 3♦.
	♠KJ ♥83 ♦AQ9854 ♣763	Bid 3NT. Your side has a combined 25-27 HCP, which is good enough for game but not for slam.

♠K2 ♥AJ3 ♦AQ987 ♣763	Bid 2NT. You have mild slam interest opposite a good diamond fit. Note that you only need a 5-card suit when transferring with a strong hand.

Opener's Rebids

Opener normally bids responder's suit. The only exception is if opener has a good hand and wants to make a "super-acceptance" with 4-card support and maximum strength. In that case, opener makes the lower-ranking bid below responder's suit:

You	Partner
1NT (15-17)	2NT
?	
♠A9 ♥KQ92 ♦K652 ♣KQ5	Bid 3♣ with 17 HCP and excellent diamond support.
♠A97 ♥A952 ♦K65 ♣KJ5	Bid 3♦ with a lesser hand.

Responder's Rebids

With a weak hand, responder will pass whenever opener completes the transfer. If opener happens to make a super-acceptance, responder corrects to the trump suit to ask opener to pass.

With a hand interested in slam, responder can do one of two things...

Responder's Rebid	**Meaning**
3NT	Natural, showing a balanced hand. Non-forcing.
A new suit	Up to partnership agreement. This may be a natural suit, OR shortness. The latter is part of Bridge World Standard.

The Invitational 2NT Response

When asked which bridge convention he disliked the most, the late Bobby Goldman once answered, "Any use of 1NT - 2NT which is not natural." Nevertheless, four-suit transfers require responder to describe a natural 2NT invitation by alternative means. This is done by running game-invitational hands through Stayman first, and then rebidding 2NT.

Partner	You	
1NT (15-17)	2♣	
2♥	?	
	♠A97 ♥K2 ♦JT76 ♣T763	Bid 2NT. Your original 2♣ was supposedly Stayman, but your 2NT bid shows a natural invitation to 3NT. It does not promise four spades.

To show a 4-card spade suit, responder must use Stayman and then rebid 2♠, like so:

Partner	You	
1NT (15-17)	2♣	
2♥	?	
	♠AT97 ♥K2 ♦JT76 ♣T76	Bid 2♠ to show your 4-card suit. Opener should raise with 4 spades or correct to no-trumps.

See also

- Jacoby Transfers
  Another convention invented by Oswald Jacoby, used after partner opens the bidding in no-trumps.
- Minor Suit Transfers
  Transfers into clubs or diamonds, used after partner opens 1NT.
- South African Texas Transfers
  A variation of Texas using 4♣ and 4♦ bids.
- Texas Transfers
  Conventional major-suit transfers at the 4-level.